

Subject Description Form

Subject Code	ITC5869
Subject Title	Overseas Seminars (New York)
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Nil
Objectives	The goals of this course will enable students to: 1. understand the influences of American popular culture on fashion, all levels from high end to low, and to highlight the forces that are currently at play; 2. familiarize themselves with American consumer demographics and the psychographics of the dominant and the emerging markets in the Americas; 3. recognize the leading retail establishments of the United States, with special emphasis on New York and to understand what makes them successful in this increasingly competitive field, and 4. evaluate the effectiveness of various types of production facilities from apparel to accessories and to be able to deal more effectively with sources of domestic production.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: 1. Appreciate the socio-cultural orientations in global fashion market. 2. Manage and understand the cultural differences and similarities in an era of globalization. 3. Understand the role of America in the context, the challenges and opportunities in it.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	1. <u>Fashion and American Culture</u> The elements of Popular Culture that drive the American fashion industry, including music, film, and art; the phenomenon of celebrity as a marketing tool, an exploration of fame and its impact on branding, advertising and the sales of goods; the American obsession with sports and its impact on design and marketing. 2. <u>The Great Emporia: From Bergdorf's to Wal-Mart</u> The history of retailing in America, and the most successful specialty and department stores; the mass merchandisers that dominate the

	American retail scene, such as Wal-Mart, Sears and Target. Site visit to Bergdorf Goodman and a discussion with Ed Goodman, and meetings with representatives of companies. 3. <u>Ralph Lauren: A Marketing Juggernaut</u> The history and present day status of Ralph Lauren, the single most successful American brand in the world. A visit to the mansion on 72nd Street and Madison Avenue and a meeting with an executive from the firm. 4. <u>Shop 'till You Drop: The American Consumer</u> An exploration of the consumer behavior of the American buying public; how shopping has become an avocation for Americans. Students will present an opinion paper, drawing upon both personal and professional experiences. 5. <u>Emerging Markets: The Other Americas</u> The market potential of South America; goods and services most likely to grow in the coming decade; sourcing for manufacturing; the "Other Americas" from Canada to Central America, the untapped potential of these countries, market penetration and increased sourcing. 6. <u>Manufacturing in America</u> The "myth" and the reality of manufacturing in America, and the reasons.
Teaching/Learning Methodology	During the course of programme, students from ITC of The Hong Kong Polytechnic University, as well as those master students from Institute Francais de la Mode (IFM in Paris) and the Fashion Institute of Technology (FIT in New York) will convene for two weeks at each of the participating institutions for an intensive seminar and site visits. The purpose is to explore aspects of the fashion industry particular to that city and that region of the world. Topics to be covered include fashion influences and trend spotting, consumer behavior, major retailers and their strategies for success, and production capabilities. Each participating institution brings his unique perspective to the program. These include manufacturing, merchandising, and global supply management from ITC, marketing of luxury goods with cultural tradition and newest expression from IFM, and product development, wholesaling and retailing from FIT. While in New York students will participate in class seminars, site visits and meetings with industry leaders. Cultural excursions will be arranged for the students to encourage further interchange among the students.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed		
			1	2	3
	1. Coursework	100%	✓	✓	✓
	Total	100%			
	Case study can bring about a deep understanding of the market in the region, further the interaction with students of different cultures can enhance the leadership, organization and communication skill. Written assignment is designed for a reflection in an applied and theoretical manner.				
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact: (all in 2 weeks)				
	▪ Seminars			39 Hrs.	
	Other student study effort:				
	▪ Assignment			20 Hrs.	
	▪ Reading			46 Hrs.	
	Total student study effort			105 Hrs.	
Reading List and References	<u>Indicative Reading List and References:</u>				
	1. Bartlett, Christopher A. and Sumantra Ghoshal. Managing Across Borders: The Transnational Solution. Harvard Business School Press, 2002.				
	2. Hollenbeck, George P. and Morgan W. McCall, Jr. Developing Global Executives: The Lessons of International Experience. Harvard Business School Press, 2001.				
	3. Gross, Michael. Genuine Authentic: The Real Life of Ralph Lauren. HarperCollins publishers, 2003.				
	4. Colborne Robert. Visual Merchandising: The Business of Merchandise Presentation. Thomson Learning, January 1996. ISBN:0827357591.				
	5. Douglas, Mary, Isherwood, Baron and Asherwood, Baron. The World of Goods: Towards an Anthropology of Consumption. REV, 1996. ISBN: 0415130476.				
	6. Rabolt Nancy J., Miler, Judy K. Concepts and Cases in Retail and Merchandise Management Fairchild Books, February 1998. ISBN: 1563670860.				
	7. Solomon, Michael R. and Rabolt, Nancy J. Consumer Behavior: In Fashion. Pearson Education, September 2001. ISBN: 013081122X.				